

Speed matters

The new WiMAX 2 standard will be finalized in November



Places or Foursquare

Facebook launched its geo-location service called Places whose logo has a 4 in a square



Sony Ericsson XPERIA X10 Mini

The tiny professional

will attract you with its display that dominates proceedings, the X10 Mini Pro will captivate by its compact, almost cute dimensions. The rear is gently rounded with the bold Sony Ericsson monogram embedded in it and the "XPERIA" moniker in silver.

The three buttons on the fascia may be attractive, but they're a touch on the hard side in terms of feedback. The power/standby button on the top is also quite hard. The rocker-type volume button has minimal travel, but is pretty intuitive and usable, while the well-labelled camera button just below it feels clicky but works fine.

Since the display is a mere 2.55-inches – small by touch-screen standards, the bezel appears quite wide, especially the lower portion. The 3.5mm jack is on the top, close to the power button and Sony supplies a set of in-ear earphones.

It runs on the archaic Android 1.6. However, an Eclair update is on the cards. Although it's a basic HTML browser, regular browsing is a snap – there is less interference when resizing text, and fonts seem to be rendered well.

There are minus points too – the browser is noticeably slower than either IE or Opera Mini and the same webpage takes twice as long to load. The display resolution of 240 x 320 pixels is low. Another issue we noticed was the colours look a little deficient, and this problem didn't occur on the HD Mini that also has a 65K (OS imposed) colour restriction.

The touch-screen is fairly

sensitive, and the interface is snappy for the most. It's possible to slow things down somewhat and once or twice we noticed the menu acting up a bit with some lag, but this seems rare. While the display might seem small to use properly, the addition of a QWERTY keypad alleviates this. In fact, in retrospect, Sony Ericsson seems to have thought this out to perfection. The X10 Mini Pro scores big here, for the keypad is even more usable than the original XPERIA X1. For while the keys are small, they are well spaced out and have good travel and offer nice, positive feedback. White backlighting isn't visible in bright light.

Music performance is good, well on par of what we were expecting, giving Sony Ericsson's experience with "Walkman" class phones. The bundled earphones offer good clarity, and decent bass. In-call clarity is good, and the earpiece offers good volume, better than the HD Mini.

Video playback isn't much of an experience on account of a noticeable deficiency in colour, and the contrast that isn't too good under fluorescent lighting. Battery life isn't that great, and just two hours of talking saw our battery dip to less than 50 per cent. Charging daily is a mandatory affair.

If you are looking for a compact touchscreen with a good keypad, you might want to look it up. ₹16,000 doesn't sound much for the features on offer. The X10 Mini Pro comes highly recommended.

Specifications

OS: Android 1.6; CPU: Qualcomm MSM7227 600 MHz; RAM: 128 MB; Battery: 930 mAh; Display: 2.55-inches (240 x 320 pixels); Weight: 120 grams

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Price: ₹16,000

7.5
10

Features.....	7.5
Performance.....	8.0
Build Quality.....	7.5
Value for money.....	7.0

Enter the X10 Mini Pro, a phone born from the much-touted XPERIA X10. One look at the Mini Pro will have you going "It's a joke, is that really a phone, or a toy"? – It's that small.

The Mini Pro is an attractive phone. What it lacks in dimensions it makes up in curves and contour. Every part of this handset exudes quality – from the glossy black front to the rubberised finish on the rear. The entire phone is black, relieved only by a chrome bezel running around it and three adjacent chrome buttons, designed to appear as a bold slash below the screen. Owing to its compact size, the Mini Pro feels solidly reassuring in-hand. Even the side-slide QWERTY keypad has a very positive feel to it and the mechanism snaps solidly into place. While the HTC HD Mini